Carboplatin every 3 weeks with head and neck radiotherapy

Carboplatin is given with radiotherapy to treat locally advanced head and neck cancer when cisplatin is unsuitable. Your team explains the intended chance of cure or long-term control for your diagnosis.

Locally advanced stage III–intravenous (IV) head and neck squamous cell carcinoma when cisplatin is not appropriate. · NCCP 00261 v7 · Document revised 9 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

Locally advanced stage III–IV head and neck squamous cell carcinoma when cisplatin is not appropriate.

My overall treatment

Carboplatin every 3 weeks × 3 with radiotherapy.

21 day view

Treatment timing in this window

Carboplatin treatment — Day 1

Carboplatin with radiotherapy

Carboplatin is given through a vein over about 30 minutes on Day 1 every 21 days. The head and neck prescription uses AUC 5, a target used with your checked kidney function to calculate the dose. The whole visit includes safety checks, anti-sickness medicines, preparation and observation. Three carboplatin cycles are planned with concurrent radiotherapy. Radiation has a separate appointment calendar; the team coordinates any interruptions or changes.

Recovery and follow-up

Continue mouth, swallowing, dental, skin and nutrition care after radiation. Blood tests and hearing or nerve review follow any persisting problem; scans and examinations follow your individual oncology and radiation plan.

A typical 21-day cycle

Day 1	Day 2–21
Treatment visit	Between visits

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before	**Baseline safety and preparation** NCCP	Full blood count, kidney and liver tests; review kidney-function measurement, earlier platinum reactions, nerve and hearing symptoms and all medicines.
During	**Bloods, symptoms and support** NCCP	Full blood count, kidney and liver tests before every cycle. The team verifies the current kidney result and dose calculation, and reviews infection, bleeding, hearing and nerve symptoms.
After / response	**Follow-up and tests** NCCP / individual plan	Continue mouth, swallowing, dental, skin and nutrition care after radiation. Blood tests and hearing or nerve review follow any persisting problem; scans and examinations follow your individual oncology and radiation plan.

Between treatments

- Radiation has its own calendar. Mouth, skin and swallowing effects can build across weeks and continue afterwards.
- Take your prescribed anti-sickness medicines and seek help early for poor intake, fever or bleeding.

Bring your medicine list, test dates, treatment calendar and actual urgent contacts.

When to get help

Call 112 / **999** for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Hearing / tinnitus

Carboplatin

Report hearing change or ringing in the ears; previous platinum treatment increases risk.

3 Blood cells / infection

Carboplatin

Fever, shivering, sudden illness, unusual bruising or bleeding needs prompt oncology advice.

5 Nausea / appetite

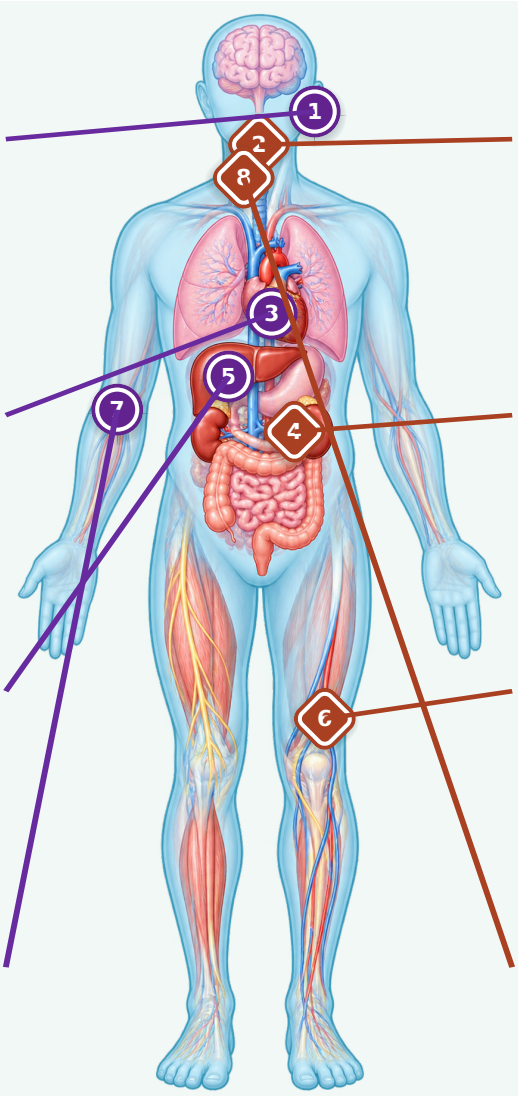
Carboplatin

Take the prescribed prevention and rescue medicines. Call if vomiting persists or fluids will not stay down.

7 Skin / treated area

Radiotherapy

Follow the radiation team’s skin plan. Report painful redness, peeling or a wound that is not healing.



2 Mouth / throat / saliva

Head and neck radiotherapy

Mouth pain, thick saliva, dry mouth or swallowing difficulty can limit drinking; seek help early.

4 Kidneys / fluids

Carboplatin

Kidney tests guide the carboplatin dose. Much less urine, persistent vomiting or inability to drink needs urgent advice.

6 Nerves / hands / feet

Carboplatin

Report numbness, tingling, balance problems or difficulty with fine tasks; symptoms can persist.

8 Teeth / jaw / swallowing

Head and neck radiotherapy

Dental review, nutrition and swallowing support continue through recovery. Report jaw stiffness, weight loss or choking.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Contact oncology promptly for fever, shivering, sudden illness, unusual bleeding, persistent vomiting, much less urine or inability to drink. Report worsening hearing, numbness or tingling before the next dose. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse or severe chest pain is an emergency.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital’s temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

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Keep your treatment details to hand

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Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Carboplatin · head and neck

Every 21 days × 3 with radiotherapy

Phase: _____ Planned cycles: 3

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678

Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My cycle record

Team stamps after each completed cycle.

C1	C2	C3
Date / initials	Date / initials	Date / initials

My treatment information

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

CUT outer border

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____
Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.